



City Commission Agenda Report

City of Kalamazoo

Date: **3/2/2026**

Item: **H.1.**

TO: Mayor Anderson, Vice Mayor Duncan, and City Commissioners

FROM: Malcolm Hankins, City Manager
Reviewed by: James J Baker, Public Services Director and City Engineer
Prepared by: Kerry Lyn Williams, Grants Division Manager

DATE: March 2, 2026

SUBJECT: Approval of a contract with Wightman for the design of West Michigan, South, and Lovell Street (Bid Ref#92549-004.0)

RECOMMENDATION:

It is recommended that the City Commission approve a contract with Wightman for the design of West Michigan, South, and Lovell Street in the amount of \$3,000,000 funded through a RAISE 2022 Planning Grant.

BACKGROUND:

This design work is the first phase of the project to convert West Michigan, South, and Lovell streets (including the "spaghetti bowl" intersection) from one way to two way operation and support multi-modal transportation through this western end of the Downtown Kalamazoo Transportation Network. The goals of the project include improved safety, connectivity, and ease in use for all modes of transport. The project is funded through the RAISE Planning grant received by the City of Kalamazoo in 2023. These changes meet the community's goals of streets that are safe and comfortable for all users. This work will have a profound impact on economic vitality in and around Downtown and reconnect the Downtown with adjacent neighborhoods.

Eight proposals were received by the deadline given in the City's publicly issued and advertised Request for Proposal process; one of these proposals was deemed non-responsive. A comprehensive project team was assembled to review and compare the seven remaining proposals using an MDOT-approved qualifications-based selection method. Wightman's proposal had the highest cumulative score and was selected based on its conveyed understanding of the project scope, the firm's experience, and its project delivery abilities.

STRATEGIC VISION ALIGNMENT:

Strategic Goal Impact:

Complete Neighborhoods - residential areas that support the full range of people's daily needs

Economic Vitality - A supportive infrastructure for growing businesses and stabilizing the local economy for the benefit of all.

Connected City - A City networked for walking, biking, riding, and driving

Environmental Responsibility - A green and healthy City.

Inviting Public Places - Vibrant streets, exceptional parks, and welcoming activities.

Safe Community- Creating a safe environment for living, working, and playing

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT:

Appropriate Depth of Engagement

Co-lead/Empower (two-way conversation) - the community will have a chance to shape the project and give final approval.

The RFP and bid response intentionally incorporate significant public engagement throughout the entire design process.

FISCAL IMPACT:

The funds required for this contract are \$3,000,000. Funds are from the previously approved RAISE Planning Grant (subrecipient agreement with MDOT).

Description	Account	Project #	Dollar Amount
Contract for Preliminary and Final Design, funded through the RAISE Planning grant.		mst0100271	\$3,000,000